MONTHLY UPDATE

Sierra Leone: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Energy · Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services

DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
India activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

DATA GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

- **Ministry of Communication strengthens partnership with UN on digital transformation** — Sierra Loaded, 5 September 2026

  Data Governance Framework in development; Government Data Centre at NatCA Tower, redundancy site at State House.

OPEN SOURCE SOFTWARE POLICY

- **Sierra Leone to showcase open-source software policy at UNGA 81** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

  The communications ministry will take its open-source software agenda to a side event at the United Nations General Assembly on 24 September, with a UN partner, arguing open source supports affordable, secure and locally owned digital systems.

- **UNGA81: Sierra Leone unveils Open Source Policy to address digital fragmentation and vendor lock-in** — Tech Review Africa, 25 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications ministry presented a new open source policy at a UNICEF event on the sidelines of UNGA81, as its answer to duplicated government systems, rising proprietary costs, systems that cannot interoperate and vendor lock-in. The policy's text, adoption date and instrument were not given.

Legislation and regulation

DIGITAL GOVERNMENT BILL

- **Government Reviews Security of Children s Vaccination Data** — Sierra Loaded, 11 September 2026

  16 ministries work four child-data use cases; National Data Protection Policy approved, Digital Government Bill with AG.

Data protection

GUARDRAILS FOR CHILDREN'S DATA IN PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Sierra Leone enhances child data protection in connected government systems** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026

  Sierra Leone is strengthening safeguards for children's personal data as government institutions move toward more connected digital public infrastructure. The communication, technology and innovation ministry, with a United Nations children's agency and a digital public infrastructure centre, ran a three-day workshop on guardrails for children examining how government systems handle their data.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

GOVERNMENT WIDE AND LOCAL AREA NETWORKS (GWAN AND GLANS)

- **Procurement Review Panel Probes Alleged Irregularities in Digital Transformation Project** — Truth Media Sierra Leone, 21 September 2026

  Tiwai Memory Masters complaint over GWAN/GLANS contract SL-MOF-526879-NC-RFP; outcome to be made public.

- **IPRP Vindicates MoCTI** — Black News, 8 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's procurement review panel dismissed a bidder's complaint over the evaluation of the World Bank-funded government network contract. It directed the ministry to open financial proposals and proceed to award.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID COMPUTING PILOT AT RURAL MINI-GRIDS

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026

  KENYA DRC AFRICA

  Compute as mini-grid anchor customer; Kenya, DRC, Sierra Leone pilots for about 85,000 people; community load first.

Cybersecurity

ROAD SAFETY AUTHORITY VEHICLE LICENSING SYSTEM

- **SLRSA Alerts Public On Fake Vehicle Licences After Cyber Attack, 5 Arrested** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 5 October 2026

  Public notice of 2 October 2026; five non-staff arrested; fake-licence count undisclosed; verification at SLRSA offices.

NATIONAL INTERNET DOMAIN REGISTRY COMPROMISE OF 25 SEPTEMBER 2026

- **Sierra Leone: Government confirms cyberattack on 44 websites** — This Day (Salone), 9 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's communications ministry confirmed that 44 website addresses, one a government institution's, were hit on 25 September through the system that administers the national internet domain. Service was restored the same day; how the attackers got in has not been made public.

DPI

Data Exchange

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA ZAMBIA

  Two-day accelerator session, 2–3 Sept 2026: delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Zambia.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA ZAMBIA AFRICA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

ASYCUDA CUSTOMS SYSTEM

- **NRA Prepares to Launch Digital Customs System at Jendema Border** — Sierraloaded, 6 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's revenue authority has begun consultations with security agencies and local stakeholders at the Jendema border crossing as it prepares to launch the ASYCUDA World customs system there. The system will automate import, export and transit procedures; no launch date is given.

Digital Payments and Fintech

SMART GOODS AND SERVICES TAX MACHINES

- **NRA Begins Nationwide Distribution of Smart GST Machines to 10,000 Businesses** — The Calabash Newspaper, 2 September 2026

  10,000 GST-registered businesses targeted; rollout announced 31 August 2026.

PENSION AND SOCIAL SECURITY SELF-SERVICE APPLICATION

- **NASSIT Set to Launch New Mobile App for Pensioners** — Sierra Loaded, 7 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's social security trust is to launch a self-service application for pensioners and contributors, with a short-code fallback for feature phones, biometric verification and integration with the three mobile-money services. It is announced rather than launched, with no date published.

Registries

NATIONAL LAND TITLE CERTIFICATION

- **Land Title Certificate: A Blow To The Vulnerable?** — Apex News Sierra Leone, 14 September 2026

  Cabinet approved a nationwide land title certificate system, still needing parliamentary approval.

- **Sierra Leone: Govt. plans free nationwide land registration, minister says** — This Day Sierra Leone, 15 September 2026

  The lands minister said the government plans free nationwide land registration and title certification, with systematic registration of parcels across the country.

Sectoral management information systems

HEALTH DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (DPI-H) ARCHITECTURE AND IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

- **NMSA MIS Manager Participates in Health Digital Infrastructure Workshop** — Sierraloaded, 19 September 2026

  DPI-H convergence workshop, 17-18 Sept 2026: ecosystem mapping, costing; technical working group to validate the plan.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SIERRASEAT AUDIT MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Audit Service Sierra Leone Advances Digital Transformation with SierraSeat Post-Configuration Training** — AFROSAI-E, 3 September 2026

  World Bank-funded audit MIS clears user acceptance testing; 25 ASSL staff trained 3-5 August 2026.

VISION-SL MINISTERIAL PERFORMANCE PLATFORM

- **Chief Minister digitises Ministerial performance to strengthen accountability** — Concord Times, 12 October 2026

  VISION-SL platform for performance contracts, targets and quarterly reports, shown to MDAs ahead of validation.

Technology

AI

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN THE 2028 ELECTIONS

- **ONS Warns AI Deepfakes Could Threaten Trust and Election Security Ahead of 2028** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 16 September 2026

> ONS warns AI deepfakes threaten public trust and the integrity of the 2028 general elections.

> DEEPFAKE AND DIGITAL MISINFORMATION CAMPAIGN

- **Sierra Leone launches AI, deepfake campaign** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  Sierra Leone launched a national artificial-intelligence and deepfake awareness campaign in Freetown, planned in two phases across all 16 districts. It is led by the Directorate of Science, Technology and Innovation with the communications and information ministries, and funded through the World Bank's digital transformation project.

> NATIONAL AI ROADMAP FOR THE JUSTICE SECTOR

- **Sierra Leone to develop national AI roadmap for justice sector with UNESCO support** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's judiciary and the attorney-general's office are to draft a national artificial-intelligence roadmap for the justice sector with UNESCO, beginning with the security sector. Participants at the convening pointed to electronic filing and digital case management; no timetable is given.

Innovation ecosystem

> STARTUP ACT

- **First Lady Fatima Bio Leads Official Launch of 'Flot' Digital Financial Platform** — Sierraloaded, 12 September 2026

  Launched 12 Sep 2026; minister flags a Startup Act for Q1 2027 and an Innovation Investment Fund.

> DIGITAL PUBLIC GOODS PIPELINE

- **UNGA81: Four Sierra Leonean teams submit Digital Public Goods to Global Registry** — Tech Review Africa, 25 September 2026

  Four Sierra Leonean teams met all nine Digital Public Goods criteria and submitted their products to the global registry, it was announced at a UNICEF event at UNGA81, with three more teams meeting six or seven criteria. The Christex Foundation, which prepared them over six to seven months, used its own AI-assisted assessment tool, Pipeline.

- **UNGA81: Sierra Leone unveils Open Source Policy to address digital fragmentation and vendor lock-in** — Tech Review Africa, 25 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Capacity

Literacy

> NATIONAL AI AND DEEPFAKE SENSITIZATION CAMPAIGN

- **Information Minister Launches National AI, Deepfake Sensitization Campaign** — The Nationalist, 17 September 2026

  info.gov.sl QR-code verification one-stop shop planned; national AI policy under development.

Training and skills

> CIVIL SERVICE DIGITAL SKILLS PROGRAMME

- **Sierra Leone expands digital skills training for civil servants** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026

Cohort 1 in week two: admin staff trained on AI drafting and Google Workspace registers; cohort ends 25 Sept 2026.

Research institutions

CIPHER INFORMATION PRIVACY RESEARCH CENTRE

- **CIPHER Launched to Promote Data Protection, Cybersecurity and Digital Privacy** — Truth Media, 9 October 2026

  Freetown research centre on data mishandling; training for controllers; aims to steer policy into law.

Inclusion

Access to services

DPI INCLUSIVITY SURVEY

- **Global Development Network kicks off deployment of its five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey** — Global Development Network — Inclusive Digital Transformation Hub, 7 September 2026 GHANA GLOBAL

  The Global Development Network has begun fieldwork on a five-country DPI Inclusivity Survey covering Sierra Leone and Ghana alongside Chile, Bangladesh and Indonesia, with partner teams at the Institute for Development and the University of Ghana. Running to April and engaging more than 5,000 households, it asks whether digital identity and digital payment systems leave people feeling more economically, socially and politically included, rather than measuring registration and access.

IDENTITY REGISTRATION OF PERSONS IN CORRECTIONAL CUSTODY

- **NCRA Marks International Identity Day with Registration Drive for 100 Inmates** — The Calabash Newspaper, 18 September 2026

  100 inmates from three Freetown centres enrolled for NINs on 17 Sept 2026; ID cards free, cost met by Government.

Data

National statistics

2025 VITAL STATISTICS REPORT

- **NCRA Begins Validation of Sierra Leone's 2025 Vital Statistics Report** — Sierra Loaded, 11 September 2026

  Two-day validation of the draft 2025 report, 10-11 September 2026; fertility and mortality the focus.

2026 POPULATION AND HOUSING CENSUS

- **Sierra Leone's President Bio Calls For Faster Development Delivery, Stronger Coordination At DEPAC Meeting** — Office of the President of Sierra Leone, 11 September 2026

  US$37m census financing gap; US$24m committed by government, US$15m disbursed, Census Night 1 Dec 2026.

- **Stats SL Completes Nationwide Mapping Ahead of December Census** — Sierraloaded, 18 September 2026

  Statistics Sierra Leone completed nationwide mapping for the December 2026 census, the country's first digital census, and the census technical committee received the mapping completion report on 15 September. The committee also reviewed an August mock census; Census Night is set for 1 December.

- **Stats SL Completes Mapping, Deploys Digital Systems Ahead of 2026 Census** — SierraLoaded, 7 October 2026

  500 tablets, ArcGIS Pro and satellite imagery; over US$20m in preparations; CAPI enumeration 2-16 Dec 2026.

- **2026 Census Budget Rises From $7 Million to Nearly $60 Million – Stats SL Boss Andrew Johnny** — SierraLoaded, 12 October 2026

  Revised after cartographic mapping; covers enumeration to dissemination; government, donors and private sector to fund.

- **Sierra Leone counts down to first fully digital census** — The Sierra Leone Telegraph, 13 October 2026

  Sierra Leone opened the 50-day countdown to its 2026 Population and Housing Census, its first fully digital enumeration. Census Night is 1 December and nationwide enumeration starts the next day.

Geopolitics

India activities

INDIA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE LEARNING MISSION

- **Karnataka Hosts African Union, Five African Nations For Digital Public Infrastructure Exposure Visit** — The Bengaluru Live, 1 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA ZAMBIA

  AU plus Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia study Karnataka DPI; UNDP-supported.

- **African Delegations Explore India's Digital Public Infrastructure During UNDP Learning Mission** — Youth Village Zambia, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA

  Five African delegations tour Aadhaar, UPI and DigiLocker on a UNDP South-South mission.

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